



America's Expansion

The US just made it's first move to make space part of American territory. Read on to see how <http://dgit.in/whxpan>



Humans are slacker mammals

Humans and other primates burn 50% fewer calories than other mammals <http://dgit.in/SlowBozo>

Space Age

The Extreme Awesomeness of the Universe

When it comes to the Universe - infinity is just the beginning. Here's a very broad look at the awesome scale of the universe

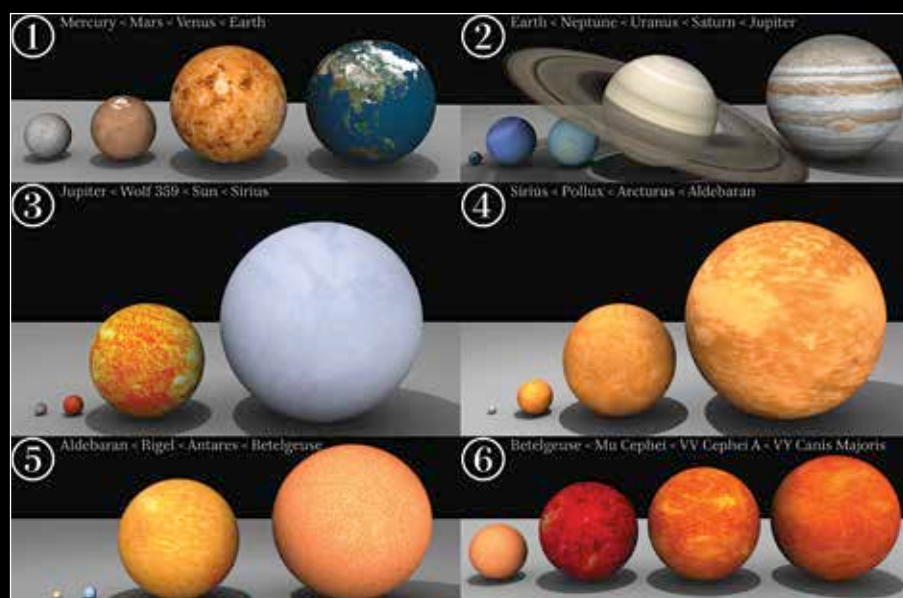
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"Modern science has been a voyage into the unknown, with a lesson in humility waiting at every stop. Many passengers would rather have stayed home."

– Carl Sagan

As 2013 was coming to an end, astronomers interpreting 15 years worth of data documenting the distant state of the universe came to an astounding discovery. The trio of Istvan Horvath, Jon Hakkila, and Zolt Bagoly saw something strange in the data that contradicted the very foundations of astrophysics - they called it the Hercules-Corona Borealis Great Wall.

This immense superstructure of galaxies held together by gravity is the largest structure in the observable universe. It measures more than 10 billion light years across and exists in violation of the cosmological principle. The principle is an axiom that dictates that when the universe is observed on a large enough scale then matter is found to be homogeneously distributed. But the dense superstructure of Hercules-Corona



In the Universe, size is always a relative thing, never to be taken for granted.

Borealis Great Wall flies in the face of that rule and has sent scientists scuttling back to the drawing board.

The hierarchy of astronomical structures most people are familiar with - moons, planets, stars, solar systems, galaxies and universe - is far more complex than ever imagined. Galaxies themselves are a generalisation of clusters, sheets, walls, filaments and voids that together are considered to be one unit. But as detailed research continues scientists have discovered amazing scale of structures just by observing the interconnectedness of the clusters and filaments.

In recognition of how easily the universe can turn decades of human scientific thought on its head we present a series of astronomical phenomenon that demonstrates the awesome scale of the universe.

The Cosmic Web

One of the oddest and definitely largest gravitationally interconnected super structures of the Universe – the Cosmic Web – was discovered in January of 2014 when the quasar UM287 illuminated a section of space revealing a vast network of filaments that spread out across the galaxies in a three dimensional web. Researchers at the University of California, Santa Cruz took the first image of this cosmic web with the 10-meter Keck 1 Telescope in Hawaii.

This new discovery of a far reaching nebula is twice the size of anything ever recorded before and the first to show how the filaments are organised together to create this web. Using computer simulations based on gathered large scale dark matter data that was illuminated when the